Resources for verifying information

Tools that can help us CHECK

In chapter 03, we learned how to verify information: find where it comes from, reach the original source, check the data, look at the date and context, compare it with other sources and check whether an image or video really corresponds to what we are being told.

But knowing what to check is only one part of the process.

We also need to know where to look and which tools can help.

Here we bring together useful resources for putting the CHECK step of the AntiFake checklist into

Tools that can help us CHECK

practice.

We do not need to use all of them. We choose the tool according to what we need to verify.

If we have an image

A photograph can be real and still be used to misinform.

It may have been taken in another country, belong to another period or have circulated years earlier in connection with a completely different event.

Google Lens allows us to search for an image or part of it and find visually similar images and related content online. This can help us discover whether a photograph has appeared before and in what context.

InVID-WeVerify is a more advanced verification tool. Among other functions, it allows reverse image

If we have an image

searches, video analysis and the extraction of frames to search for their origin.

It can be particularly useful when a video circulates on social media and we want to know whether the images are old, come from another place or have circulated before.

InVID-WeVerify.

Finding out whether a false rumour has already been checked

Before starting a verification from scratch, we can look for organisations that investigate different types of content, especially false rumours.

Verificat is a Catalan fact-checking platform that checks content circulating on social media. It provides fact-checks on different topics, including migration.

Maldita.es also verifies disinformation and publishes the sources and process it uses to reach its conclusions.

When a message uses figures or statistics

If we encounter phrases such as:

“The majority…”

“70%…”

“Every year…”

“The data show that…”

we can ask:

Where does this figure come from?

For Catalonia, consult Idescat, the Institut d’Estadística de Catalunya, the Statistical Institute of Catalonia.

When a message uses figures or statistics

For Spain, consult the Instituto Nacional de Estadística, INE, the National Statistics Institute.

AntiFake resources: quick reference

I need to find the origin or context of an image

I can use Google Lens to find visually similar images and related content, and investigate whether the image appeared before in another context.

I need to examine an image or video in more detail

I can use InVID-WeVerify to analyse images or videos and investigate the origin of video frames.

I need to know whether content has already been checked

I can consult Verificat or Maldita.es. These organisations specialise in investigating content circulating on social media and the wider web and identifying false or misleading claims.

I need to check statistics about Catalonia

I can consult Idescat, the Institut d’Estadística de Catalunya. It publishes official statistics on population, work, living conditions, the economy and many other areas.

I need to check statistics about Spain

I can consult INE, the Instituto Nacional de Estadística. It publishes statistics for Spain as a whole, including specific population statistics.

Remember: a tool does not think for us

Google Lens can help us find a photograph.

Idescat can give us a piece of data.

A fact-checker may have investigated a false rumour.

But no tool replaces our critical perspective.

We still need to ask where the information comes from, what the context is, whether the source is appropriate, what the data really says and whether what we found proves the message's claim.

That is why these tools do not replace the AntiFake checklist.

Remember: a tool does not think for us

They help us put it into practice.

Verification tools and sources change and evolve. This section will therefore be updated as we find new reliable sources, useful resources and verification tools that help us cross-check information better.

AntiFake is not a closed tool: it also learns, cross-checks and updates itself.

If we want to check information about racism, migration and borders

Not all the information we need to verify can be found in an official database or on a fact-checking platform.

When analysing information about racism, migration or borders, we can also consult specialist organisations that research, document and publish information on these realities.

SOS Racisme Catalunya publishes reports and data on racism and discrimination in Catalonia, drawing, among other sources, on cases collected by its

If we want to check information about racism, migration and borders

Servei d’Atenció i Denúncia, SAiD, the support and reporting service. Its materials can help us check information about racism, discrimination, hate speech and rights violations.

Caminando Fronteras researches and documents what happens along migration routes and at borders. Its reports and monitoring can be especially useful when we need to check information about migration routes, disappearances, deaths and violations of the right to life at borders.

One important point: no source can verify everything

A source can be highly reliable and still not be the appropriate source for answering a particular question.

If we want to check a population figure, we can look for an official statistical source.

If we want to know whether a photograph has circulated before, we can use a reverse image search tool.

If we want to investigate racism or discrimination, we can consult specialist organisations.

If we want to check information about deaths or

One important point: no source can verify everything

disappearances along a migration route, we need sources that investigate that specific reality.

Verification also means knowing which source we need to answer the question we are asking.